

Backend Configuration & Data Setup – Incident Table Custom Fields Configuration

Incident Table Custom Fields Configuration

Overview

To support proactive SLA governance, the **Incident** table is extended with custom fields that capture SLA-related information. These fields enable the system to record breach reasons, justifications, user acknowledgements, and SLA risk status.

The custom fields serve as the foundation for **Flow Designer automation, UI Policies, Virtual Agent interactions, reports, and governance dashboards**. They also ensure that every potential SLA breach is documented consistently and remains available for audit and performance analysis.

Objective

The objectives of this configuration are to:

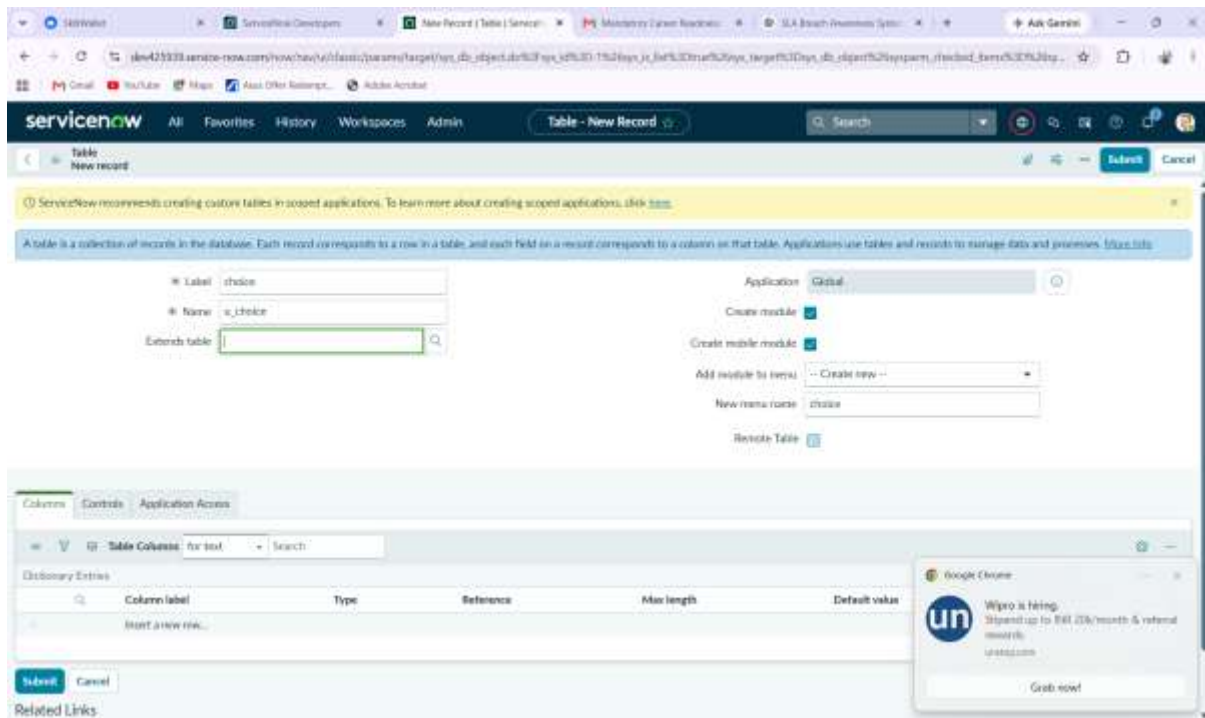
- Extend the Incident table with SLA governance fields.
 - Capture standardized SLA breach reasons.
 - Record detailed breach justifications.
 - Track SLA acknowledgement by the assigned user.
 - Identify incidents that are approaching SLA breach.
 - Provide data for reporting, dashboards, and compliance audits.
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Navigation

Navigate to the Incident table using:

System Definition → Tables

Search for **Incident** and open the **Incident** table.



Step 1: Create Custom Fields

Click **New** in the **Columns** related list and create the following fields.

Field Label	Data Type	Purpose
SLA Breach Reason	Choice	Stores the predefined reason for an SLA breach.
SLA Breach Justification	String	Stores the explanation for the SLA breach. (<i>Use String, not Journal Input.</i>)
SLA Acknowledgement	True/False	Indicates whether the assignee has acknowledged the SLA warning.
SLA At Risk	True/False	Identifies whether the Incident is approaching SLA breach.

After creating all fields, click **Save**.

Step 2: Configure Choice Values

Open the **SLA Breach Reason** field and configure the following choice values.

Choice Values

Value	Description
Dependency on Third Party	Delay caused by an external vendor or third-party service.
Awaiting User Response	Incident is pending information or action from the requester.
Incorrect Categorization	Delay caused by assigning the wrong category or assignment group.
System Outage	Resolution delayed due to infrastructure or system failure.
Approval Delay	Incident resolution is waiting for required approvals.
Other	Any other reason not covered by the predefined options.

Save each choice after adding it.

Field Descriptions

SLA Breach Reason (Choice)

This field captures the primary reason why an Incident is approaching or has exceeded its SLA.

Using predefined values ensures:

- Standardized documentation
- Consistent reporting
- Easier trend analysis
- Better governance

SLA Breach Justification (String)

This field stores a detailed explanation of the circumstances that led to the SLA breach.

Important: Use the **String** data type as specified. **Do not use Journal Input**, since the value must be stored as structured data for reporting and governance.

SLA Acknowledgement (True/False)

This field records whether the assigned user has acknowledged the SLA warning.

Possible values:

- **True** – User has acknowledged the SLA risk.
- **False** – SLA warning has not yet been acknowledged.

This field is updated during the Virtual Agent conversation or Incident update process.

SLA At Risk (True/False)

This field identifies incidents approaching the SLA threshold.

Possible values:

- **True** – Incident is nearing SLA breach.
- **False** – Incident is within normal SLA limits.

This field is automatically updated by Flow Designer when the configured SLA threshold is reached.

Usage of Custom Fields

These fields are used throughout the project:

Component	Usage
Flow Designer	Detects SLA risk and updates SLA At Risk .
Email Notifications	Alerts users when SLA At Risk = True .
UI Policies	Makes breach reason, justification, and acknowledgement mandatory.
Virtual Agent	Collects acknowledgement, breach reason, and justification.
Reports & Dashboards	Displays SLA trends, breach reasons, and compliance metrics.
Audit & Governance	Maintains complete documentation of SLA-related activities.

Validation

After configuration, verify the following:

- All four custom fields are visible on the Incident form.

- **SLA Breach Reason** displays the six configured choice values.
 - **SLA Breach Justification** uses the **String** data type.
 - **SLA Acknowledgement** is a **True/False** field.
 - **SLA At Risk** is a **True/False** field.
 - The fields are available for Flow Designer, UI Policies, Virtual Agent, reports, and dashboards.
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Expected Outcome

After completing this configuration:

- Incident records contain all required SLA governance fields.
 - Users can select standardized breach reasons.
 - Detailed justifications are stored consistently.
 - SLA acknowledgement is tracked.
 - SLA risk status is available for automation.
 - Reporting and dashboards provide accurate governance metrics.
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Benefits

- Standardized SLA breach documentation.
 - Improved governance and accountability.
 - Accurate reporting and analytics.
 - Simplified Virtual Agent interactions.
 - Better audit readiness.
 - Zero-code implementation using native ServiceNow features.
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Conclusion

The custom field configuration on the **Incident** table provides the essential data structure required for the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. By adding fields for breach reason, justification, acknowledgement, and SLA risk, the system can automate governance processes, support user interactions

through the Virtual Agent, generate meaningful reports, and maintain comprehensive audit-ready records. These fields form the backbone of the project's SLA governance framework.